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United States Patent	12415534
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	September 16, 2025
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Vehicle system and storage medium

Abstract

A vehicle system: estimates a position of a host vehicle; acquires, from outside of the host vehicle, a probe data map generated based on probe data; recognizes periphery information indicating a periphery of the host vehicle using a detection result of an autonomous sensor; specifies an attention point using the probe data map; recognizes a driver status; compares feature information indicated by the probe data map with the periphery information of the host vehicle and determines whether the probe data map has a high quality or a low quality; determines, based on the driver status, whether the driver performs a safety confirmation for the attention point indicated by the probe data map when the probe data map is determined to have the high quality; and notifies the driver of a determination result of the safety confirmation.

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Appl. No.: 18/421388

Filed: January 24, 2024

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20240157961 A1	May. 16, 2024

Foreign Application Priority Data

JP	2021-128410	Aug. 04, 2021
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Related U.S. Application Data

continuation parent-doc WO PCT/JP2022/026595 20220704 PENDING child-doc US 18421388

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: **B60W50/14** (20200101); **B60W40/08** (20120101); **G01C21/00** (20060101); **G06V20/56** (20220101); **G06V20/59** (20220101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC **B60W50/14** (20130101); **B60W40/08** (20130101); **G01C21/3841** (20200801); **G01C21/387** (20200801); **G06V20/56** (20220101); **G06V20/597** (20220101); B60W2050/143 (20130101); B60W2050/146 (20130101); B60W2420/403 (20130101); B60W2540/229 (20200201); B60W2556/25 (20200201); B60W2556/40 (20200201); B60W2556/45 (20200201)

Field of Classification Search

CPC: B60W (50/14)

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Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) The present application is a continuation application of International Patent Application No. PCT/JP2022/026595 filed on Jul. 4, 2022, which designated the U.S. and claims the benefit of priority from Japanese Patent Application No. 2021-128410 filed on Aug. 4, 2021. The entire disclosures of all of the above applications are incorporated herein by reference.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The present disclosure relates to a vehicle system and a storage medium storing a driving diagnosis program.

BACKGROUND

(2) In a related art, a vehicle system transmits, to a driving diagnosis server, driving state information indicating a state of vehicle being driven by a driver. Then, the driving diagnosis server performs a driving diagnosis based on the driving state information transmitted from the vehicle system.

SUMMARY

(3) The present disclosure provides a vehicle system. The vehicle system: estimates a position of a host vehicle; acquires, from outside of the host vehicle, a probe data map generated based on probe data; recognizes periphery information indicating a periphery of the host vehicle using a detection result of an autonomous sensor that detects the periphery information of the host vehicle; specifies an attention point using the probe data map; recognizes a status of a driver of the host vehicle; compares feature information indicated by the probe data map with the periphery information of the host vehicle indicated by the detection result of the autonomous sensor and determines whether the probe data map has a high quality or a low quality; determines, based on the status of the driver, whether the driver performs a safety confirmation for the attention point indicated by the probe data map when the probe data map is determined to have the high quality; and notifies the driver of a determination result indicating whether the driver has performed the safety confirmation.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

- (1) Objects, features and advantages of the present disclosure will become apparent from the following detailed description made with reference to the accompanying drawings. In the drawings:
- (2) FIG. 1 is a block diagram showing a configuration of vehicle system according to an embodiment of the present disclosure;
 - (3) FIG. 2 is a block diagram showing an overall configuration including a non-vehicle system;
 - (4) FIG. 3 is a flowchart showing a probe data transmission process;
 - (5) FIG. 4 is a flowchart showing a driving diagnosis process;
 - (6) FIG. 5 is a flowchart showing a driving diagnosis process;
 - (7) FIG. 6 is a diagram showing a mode in which driving attention information is displayed in the vehicle system;
 - (8) FIG. 7 is a diagram showing a mode in which a driving diagnosis result is displayed in the vehicle system; and
 - (9) FIG. 8 is a diagram showing a mode in which a driving diagnosis result is displayed on a portable information terminal.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(10) Conventionally, driving diagnosis is performed based on a behavior of host vehicle, such as an accelerator operation, a brake operation, or a vehicle speed. However, there are various traveling environments around the host vehicle, such as presence or absence of pedestrians, bicycles, and oncoming vehicles. Thus, when the driving diagnosis is performed based only on the behavior of host vehicle, a proper driving diagnosis result may not be obtained. In a case where a proper driving diagnosis result cannot be obtained, the driver may fail to receive a sense of safety and security from the vehicle.

(11) According to an aspect of the present disclosure, a vehicle system includes: a vehicle position estimation unit estimating a position of a host vehicle; a probe data map acquiring unit acquiring, from outside of the host vehicle, a probe data map generated based on probe data; an autonomous sensor detecting periphery information indicating a periphery of the host vehicle; a vehicle periphery recognition unit recognizing the periphery information indicating the periphery of the host vehicle using a detection result of the autonomous sensor; an attention point specifying unit specifying an attention point using the probe data map; a driver status recognition unit recognizing a status of a driver of the host vehicle; a map quality determination unit comparing feature information indicated by the probe data map with the periphery information of the host vehicle indicated by the detection result of the autonomous sensor and determines whether the probe data map has a high quality or a low quality; a safety confirmation determination unit determining, based on the status of the driver, whether the driver performs a safety confirmation for the attention point indicated by the probe data map when the probe data map is determined to have the high quality; and a notification control unit notifying the driver of a determination result of the safety confirmation determination unit.

(12) Unlike the related art in which driving diagnosis is performed only based on the behavior of host vehicle, in the above-described vehicle system, the attention point is specified using the probe data map. Then, the vehicle system determines whether the driver performs safety confirmation about the attention point based on the driver status, and the determination result is notified to the driver. When the driver does not perform the safety confirmation about the attention point, the driver is notified of the necessity of safety confirmation so that the driver can perform the safety confirmation. When the driver performs the safety confirmation about the attention point, the driver is notified of the execution of safety confirmation so that a sense of safety and security from the vehicle can be appropriately notified to the driver.

(13) The following will describe an embodiment of the present disclosure with reference to the accompanying drawings. As shown in FIG. 1, a vehicle system 1 is mounted on a vehicle, and includes a data communication module (hereinafter, referred to as DCM) 2, a central electronic control unit (ECU) 3, an advanced driver assistance system (ADAS) domain ECU 4, a cockpit domain ECU 5, a body ECU 6, and a powertrain domain ECU 7.

(14) Each of the DCM 2 and the ECUs 3 to 7 includes a microcomputer having a central processing unit (CPU), a read only memory (ROM), a random access memory (RAM), and an input/output (I/O). Each microcomputer executes a computer program stored in a non-transitory tangible storage medium to execute a process corresponding to the computer program. The microcomputers control overall operations of the DCM 2 and the ECUs 3 to 7, respectively. The microcomputer is also known as a processor. The non-transitory tangible storage media may share its hardware with another computer resource. The DCM 2 and the ECUs 3 to 7 cooperate with one another to control an overall operation of the vehicle system 1.

(15) As illustrated in FIG. 2, the vehicle system 1 is connected to a map generation server 8 and a driving data management server 9 via a communication network such that the vehicle system 1 can perform data communication with an external source. For example, the communication network may include a digital communication line. The map generation server 8 may be managed by an original equipment manufacturing (OEM), a data supplier, or the like. The map generation server

integrates multiple records of probe data to generate a probe data map. The driving data management server **9** may be managed by an OEM, a data supplier, or the like, and manages driver's driving data. The driving data management server **9** may be connected to a cooperation service server **10** via a communication network such that the driving data management server **9** can perform data communication with the cooperation service server **10**. The cooperation service server **10** manages points to be given to the driver. The points given to the driver can be used in various payments, such as an insurance fee of vehicle insurance, a usage fee of parking lot, a maintenance fee of vehicle, an over the air (OTA) charge, charge for purchase of goods, and a usage fee of facility such as a movie theater or a restaurant.

(16) The vehicle system **1** has a multiple-to-one relationship with the map generation server **8** and the driving data management server **9**. That is, multiple vehicle systems **1** mounted in multiple vehicles are connected to one map generation server **8** so as to be able to perform data communication, and multiple vehicle systems **1** mounted in multiple vehicles are connected to one driving data management server **9** so as to be able to perform data communication.

(17) The DCM **2** has a vehicle-to-everything (V2X) communication function as a vehicle communication device, and performs a vehicle communication control in data communication with an infrastructure equipment that includes the map generation server **8** and the driving data management server **9**. The DCM **2** includes a probe data map acquiring unit **2a**, a first driving data transmission unit **2b**, and a second driving data transmission unit **2c**.

(18) The central ECU **3** integrally manages the ADAS domain ECU **4**, the cockpit domain ECU **5**, and the powertrain domain ECU **7**. The ADAS domain ECU **4** includes a vehicle position estimation unit **4a**, a vehicle periphery recognition unit **4b**, an attention point specifying unit **4c**, a driver status recognition unit **4d**, a map quality determination unit **4e**, a safety confirmation determination unit **4f**, and a driving participate execution unit **4g**. The cockpit domain ECU **5** includes a notification control unit **5a**.

(19) The locator **11** calculates position coordinates using various parameters included in satellite signals transmitted from global navigation satellite system (GNSS), corrects the calculated position coordinates using detection results of a gyro sensor, a vehicle speed sensor, and the like. Then, the locator **11** outputs the corrected position coordinates to the vehicle position estimation unit **4a**. The GNSS is a general term for global navigation satellite system, and includes various systems such as GPS (Global Positioning System), GLONASS (Global Navigation Satellite System), Galileo, BeiDou, and IRNSS (Indian Regional Navigational Satellite System). When the position coordinates are input from the locator **11**, the vehicle position estimation unit **4a** estimates the position of host vehicle using the input position coordinates, and outputs the estimated vehicle position to the DCM **2**.

(20) A millimeter wave radar **12** emits millimeter waves toward periphery of the host vehicle to sense a periphery of the host vehicle, and outputs the detection result to the vehicle periphery recognition unit **4b**. The millimeter wave radar **12** has advantages of high straightness, miniaturization of circuit and antenna design, high distance resolution and high angular resolution by using wide range bandwidth, and resistance to environmental changes such as weather. A sonar **13** emits, for example, ultrasonic waves to the periphery of host vehicle to sense the periphery of host vehicle, and outputs the detection result to the vehicle periphery recognition unit **4b**. The sonar **13** has an advantage of reflecting light on a glass surface or a water surface. A LiDAR (Light Detection and Ranging) **14** emits laser lights toward the periphery of host vehicle to sense the periphery of the host vehicle, and outputs the detection result to the vehicle periphery recognition unit **4b**. The LiDAR **14** has an advantage of reflecting light on a non-metal surface, and can be detected even at night or in rainfall. A camera **15** includes an image sensor such as a charge coupled device (CCD) or a complementary metal oxide semiconductor (CMOS). The camera **15** captures an image of the periphery of host vehicle, and outputs the captured camera image to the vehicle periphery recognition unit **4b**. The millimeter wave radar **12**, the sonar **13**, the LiDAR **14**,

and the camera **15** correspond to autonomous sensors. It is not necessary to provide all of the millimeter wave radar **12**, the sonar **13**, the LiDAR **14**, and the camera **15** to the host vehicle. At least one of these autonomous sensors may be provided to the host vehicle. For example, a different type of autonomous sensor may be provided separately from the millimeter wave radar **12**, the sonar **13**, the LiDAR **14**, and the camera **15**.

(21) When the detection result is input from the millimeter wave radar **12**, the detection result is input from the sonar **13**, the detection result is input from the LiDAR **14**, or the camera image is input from the camera **15**, the vehicle periphery recognition unit **4b** recognizes the periphery of host vehicle using the input detection result and camera image, and outputs the recognized periphery information indicating the periphery of host vehicle to the DCM **2**, the map quality determination unit **4e**, the safety confirmation determination unit **4f**, and the driving participate execution unit **4g**. The periphery information includes, as static information, feature information such as positions and types of marking lines, stop lines, crosswalks, and the like painted on a road surface, positions and types of traffic lights, road signs, and the like erected from the road surface, road widths, road types, the number of lanes, and the like. The periphery information includes, as dynamic static information, positions of pedestrians, bicycles, and oncoming vehicles.

(22) When the host vehicle position is input from the vehicle position estimation unit **4a** and the periphery information indicating the periphery of host vehicle is input from the vehicle periphery recognition unit **4b**, the DCM **2** transmits probe data to the map generation server **8** via the communication network. In the probe data, the input host vehicle position, the periphery information indicating the periphery of host vehicle, and corresponding time are associated with one another. The DCM **2** transmits the probe data to the map generation server **8** via the communication network, for example, at a time when the travel distance of the host vehicle reaches a certain distance, or at a time when the elapsed period from last time transmission reaches a certain period, or the like.

(23) When receiving the probe data transmitted from the vehicle system **1**, the map generation server **8** integrates multiple records of probe data transmitted from multiple vehicles to generate a probe data map. For example, every time the map generation server **8** receives the probe data transmitted from the vehicle system **1**, the map generation server **8** sequentially updates the probe data map by sequentially reflecting the feature information included in the received probe data in the latest probe data map.

(24) When a transmission condition of the probe data map is satisfied, the map generation server **8** transmits the latest probe data map to the vehicle system **1**. The map generation server **8** manages, for example, the probe data map in units of segments corresponding to sections. When the map generation server **8** receives the host vehicle position transmitted from the vehicle system **1**, the map generation server **8** specifies the probe data map of the segment corresponding to the received host vehicle position, and transmits, via the communication network, the specified probe data map to the vehicle system **1**, which is the transmission source of the host vehicle position.

(25) In the DCM **2**, when the probe data map acquiring unit **2a** receives the probe data map transmitted from the map generation server **8**, the probe data map acquiring unit **2a** outputs the received probe data map to the attention point specifying unit **4c** and the map quality determination unit **4e**.

(26) When the map quality determination unit **4e** receives the periphery information indicating the periphery of host vehicle from the vehicle periphery recognition unit **4b** and receives the probe data map from the DCM **2**, the map quality determination unit **4e** collates the probe data map with the periphery information indicating the periphery of host vehicle and determines a quality of the probe data map. For example, the map quality determination unit **4e** determines whether the feature information indicated by the probe data map matches the periphery information around the host vehicle indicated by the detection result of the autonomous sensor, and determines the quality of probe data map based on the determination result. Specifically, the map quality determination unit

4e determines whether the position and the type of feature indicated by the probe data map match the position and the type of feature included in the periphery information around the host vehicle indicated by the detection result of the autonomous sensor, and determines the quality of probe data map based on the determination result.

(27) For example, the map quality determination unit **4e** digitizes a matching degree between the feature information indicated by the probe data map and the periphery information around the host vehicle indicated by the detection result of the autonomous sensor, and compares the digitized numerical value with a predetermined threshold. The map quality determination unit **4e** determines that the probe data map has high quality when a difference between the feature information indicated by the probe data map and the periphery information around the host vehicle indicated by the detection result of the autonomous sensor is small and the numerical value indicating the matching degree is equal to or greater than the predetermined threshold value. When the map quality determination unit **4e** determines that the probe data map has high quality, the map quality determination unit **4e** outputs the probe data map determined to have high quality to the attention point specifying unit **4c**. When the map quality determination unit **4e** determines that the difference between the feature information indicated by the probe data map and the periphery information around the host vehicle indicated by the detection result of the autonomous sensor is large and the numerical value indicating the matching degree is less than the predetermined threshold value, the map quality determination unit **4e** determines that the probe data map has low quality.

(28) An external array microphone **16** outputs, to the attention point specifying unit **4c**, audio information obtained by collecting sounds around the host vehicle. The external array microphone **16** also corresponds to an autonomous sensor similarly to the millimeter wave radar **12**, the sonar **13**, the LiDAR **14**, and the camera **15** described above. When the probe data map is input from the map quality determination unit **4e**, the attention point specifying unit **4c** specifies an attention point and outputs the specifying result to the safety confirmation determination unit **4f**. The attention point is a point where the driver needs to check about safety during driving. For example, the attention point may be a blind spot of an intersection or the like. When sound information is input from the external array microphone **16**, the attention point specifying unit **4c** specifies an attention point with reference to the input sound information. When the probe data map is not input from the map quality determination unit **4e**, the attention point specifying unit **4c** specifies the attention point using the detection result of the autonomous sensor, and outputs the specification result to the safety confirmation determination unit **4f**.

(29) A driver status monitor (DSM, registered trademark) **17** that monitors a status of the driver captures a face image of the driver using a driver monitor camera, determines a face direction, a line-of-sight direction, head swing, and the like from the face image of the driver, and outputs the determination result to the driver status recognition unit **4d**.

(30) When the determination result is input from the DSM **17**, the driver status recognition unit **4d** recognizes the driver status using the determination result, and outputs driver status information indicating the recognized driver status to the DCM **2**, the safety confirmation determination unit **4f**, and the driving participate execution unit **4g**.

(31) When the safety confirmation determination unit **4f** receives the periphery information indicating the periphery of host vehicle from the vehicle periphery recognition unit **4b** and receives the driver status information from the driver status recognition unit **4d**, the safety confirmation determination unit **4f** determines whether to activate an alert with reference to the received periphery information indicating the periphery of the host vehicle and the driver status information. The safety confirmation determination unit **4f** determines whether the line of sight of the driver is directed in a direction of the attention point when the attention point occurs, determines whether the driver performs the safety confirmation based on the driver status, and determines whether it is necessary to activate the alert.

(32) When it is determined that the line of sight direction of the driver is directed to the attention

point, the safety confirmation determination unit **4f** determines that activation of alert is not necessary. When it is determined that the line of sight direction of the driver is not directed to the attention point, the safety confirmation determination unit **4f** determines that it is necessary to activate an alert, and outputs a notification instruction to the notification control unit **5a**. When the notification control unit **5a** receives the notification instruction from the safety confirmation determination unit **4f**, the notification control unit **5a** outputs an activation instruction to a head-up display (hereinafter referred to as HUD) **18**, a speaker **19**, and an ambient light **20**, and outputs the notification instruction to the body ECU **6**. The notification control unit **5a** outputs an alert at a position close to the line of sight of the driver in the HUD **18**, the speaker **19**, the ambient light **20**, and a side electronic mirror **21**, and notifies the driver of safety confirmation non-execution information indicating that the driver has not yet performed the safety confirmation.

(33) For example, the alert may be a message, an icon that prompts safety confirmation for the attention point. For example, when the line of sight of the driver is directed forward in the traveling direction of the host vehicle, the notification control unit **5a** displays a message, an icon, or the like in front of the driver on the HUD **18**. For example, when the line of sight of the driver is directed right forward in the traveling direction of the host vehicle, the notification control unit **5a** displays, on the HUD **18**, a message, an icon, or the like on the right forward portion of the driver. For example, when the line of sight of the driver is directed left forward in the traveling direction of the host vehicle, the notification control unit **5a** displays, on the HUD **18**, a message, an icon, or the like on the left forward portion of the driver. In addition, the notification control unit **5a** may control the speaker **19** to output, for example, a sound of a message for prompting performing of the safety confirmation for the attention point. By outputting the alert in the above-described manner, it is possible to make the driver aware that attention should be made to the attention point without distraction.

(34) In the DCM **2**, when the safety confirmation determination unit **4f** determines that the line of sight of the driver is directed toward the attention point and thus activation of alert is not necessary, a first driving data transmission unit **2b** transmits the driver's driving data to the driving data management server **9** via the communication network in order to perform point grant to the driver for the line of sight of the driver being directed toward the attention point, that is, the driver performing the safety confirmation. The driver's driving data includes driver information capable of specifying the driver, and information indicating the behavior of host vehicle, such as traveling position, accelerator operation, brake operation, steering operation, and vehicle speed of host vehicle.

(35) When the driving data management server **9** receives the driver's driving data transmitted from the vehicle system **1**, the driving data management server **9** transmits the received driver's driving data to the cooperation service server **10**. Upon receiving the driver's driving data transmitted from the driving data management server **9**, the cooperation service server **10** performs driving diagnosis using the received driver's driving data, and performs point grant to the driver corresponding to the driving diagnosis result of the driver. The cooperation service server **10** may assign a certain number of points regardless of the driving diagnosis result, or may assign a different number of points depending on a level of the driving diagnosis result. When the point grant is performed in association with the driver as described above, the cooperation service server **10** transmits, to the driving data management server **9**, point data for notifying the driver about point grant.

(36) When the driving data management server **9** receives the point data transmitted from the cooperation service server **10**, the driving data management server **9** transmits the received point data to the DCM **2**. When the DCM **2** receives the point data transmitted from the driving data management server **9**, the DCM **2** outputs the received point data to the safety confirmation determination unit **4f**. When the point data is input from the DCM **2**, the safety confirmation determination unit **4f** outputs a notification instruction to the notification control unit **5a**.

(37) When the notification control unit **5a** receives the notification instruction from the safety

confirmation determination unit **4f**, the notification control unit **5a** outputs an activation instruction to the HUD **18**, the speaker **19**, and the ambient light **20**, and notifies point grant information indicating the point grant. The notification control unit **5a** notifies the driver of safety confirmation execution information indicating execution state of safety confirmation by the driver. The point grant information is, for example, a message, an icon, or the like for notifying the driver that the points have been granted. The notification control unit **5a** controls, for example, the HUD **18** to display the message, the icon, or the like indicating the point grant information. The notification control unit **5a** may control the speaker **19** to output a sound effect expressing dropping of a coin, such as clanging sound, or a message indicating the point grant. By notifying the point grant information in this way, it is possible to make the driver recognize that the point has been granted by performing the safety confirmation about the attention point. Thus, it is possible to make the driver conscious of continuing the safety confirmation about the attention point.

(38) A sensor group **23** connected to an airbag **22** includes, for example, a vehicle speed sensor detecting a vehicle speed, an acceleration sensor detecting an acceleration of the vehicle, and a yaw rate sensor detecting a yaw rate of the vehicle. The sensor group outputs the detection results to the driving participate execution unit **4g**. The sensor group **23** may be connected to the ADAS domain ECU **4** or the central ECU **3**.

(39) When the driving participate execution unit **4g** receives the periphery information indicating the periphery of host vehicle from the vehicle periphery recognition unit **4b**, receives the driver status information from the driver status recognition unit **4d**, and receives the detection results from the sensor group **23** connected to the airbag **22**, the driving participate execution unit **4g** determines whether it is necessary to participate in the driving operation, which is being executed by the driver, with reference to the periphery information indicating the periphery of host vehicle, the driver status information, and the detection result, which are input from the various sources. For example, the driving participate execution unit **4g** determines whether the line of sight of the driver is directed to the traveling direction of the host vehicle, determines whether the traveling direction of the host vehicle is dangerous, determines whether the speed, the acceleration, and the yaw rate of host vehicle are normal, and the like. Then, the driving participate execution unit **4g** determines whether it is necessary to participate in the driving operation being performed by the driver.

(40) For example, the driving participate execution unit **4g** may determine that there is no need to participate in the driving operation being performed by the driver, when it is determined that (i) the line of sight of the driver is directed to the traveling direction of the host vehicle, (ii) the traveling direction of the host vehicle is not dangerous, (iii) the speed, the acceleration, and the yaw rate of the host vehicle are normal, or (iv) the driving operation is properly performed by the driver. For example, the driving participate execution unit **4g** may determine that it is necessary to participate in the driving operation being performed by the driver, when it is determined that (i) the line of sight of the driver is not directed to the traveling direction of the host vehicle, (ii) the traveling direction of the host vehicle is dangerous, (iii) the speed, the acceleration, and the yaw rate of the host vehicle are not normal, or (iv) the driving operation not properly performed by the driver. When determining that it is necessary to participate in the driving operation being performed by the driver, the driving participate execution unit **4g** outputs a driving participate instruction to the powertrain domain ECU **7**.

(41) When the driving participate instruction is input from the driving participate execution unit **4g**, the powertrain domain ECU **7** outputs the driving participate instruction to a brake device **24**. For example, a sensor group **25** connected to the brake device **24** may include a vehicle speed sensor detecting a speed of the host vehicle, an acceleration sensor detecting an acceleration of the host vehicle, and a yaw rate sensor detecting a yaw rate of the host vehicle. The sensor group **25** outputs the detection results to the brake device **24**. The sensor group **25** may be connected to the powertrain domain ECU **7** or the central ECU **3**. When receiving the driving participate instruction from the powertrain domain ECU **7**, the brake device **24** performs a collision damage reduction

brake (hereinafter, referred to as Autonomous Emergency Braking (AEB)) control using, for example, detection results of the sensor group **25**. In addition to the AEB control, steering control, attitude control, or the like may be performed as the participation in the driving operation. For example, electronic stability control (ESC) may be performed as the participation in the driving operation.

(42) In the DCM **2**, in response to determining that (i) the line of sight of the driver is directed to the traveling direction of the host vehicle, (ii) the traveling direction of the host vehicle is not dangerous, (iii) the speed, the acceleration, and the yaw rate of the host vehicle are normal, the driving participate execution unit determines that there is no need to participate in the driving operation being performed by the driver. In this case, the second driving data transmission unit **2c** transmits the driver's driving data to the driving data management server **9** via the communication network in order to perform point grant since there is no need to participate in the driving operation being performed by the driver, that is, safe driving is continuously performed even after the driver performs safety confirmation. For the driver's driving data transmitted from the second driving data transmission unit **2c**, the driving data management server **9** and the cooperation service server **10** perform the same process as when the first driving data transmission unit **2b** transmits the driver's driving data described above, and perform point grant to the driver.

(43) As described above, the point grant information is notified by the vehicle system **1** when the driver is performing the driving operation. Alternatively, the driving diagnosis result may be notified to the driver by the vehicle system **1** when the driver finishes the driving operation. For example, an address of a portable information terminal of the driver, such as a smartphone may be registered in advance. The driving diagnosis result may be transmitted from the driving data management server **9** to the registered portable information terminal of the driver via the communication network when the driver finishes the driving operation, and the driving diagnosis result may be notified to the driver by the portable information terminal.

(44) The following will describe a detailed operation of the above-described configuration with reference to FIG. **3** to FIG. **8**. The vehicle system **1** executes a probe data transmission process and a driving diagnosis process, which will be described in detail. The vehicle system **1** performs the probe data transmission process by executing a probe data transmission program, and performs the driving diagnosis process by executing a driving diagnosis program.

(45) (1) Probe Data Transmission Process (see FIG. **3**)

(46) The vehicle system **1** starts the probe data transmission process when a start condition of the probe data transmission process is satisfied, for example, an ignition switch of the vehicle is turned on. When the probe data transmission process is started, the vehicle system **1** estimates, in S1, the host vehicle position by the vehicle position estimation unit **4a** using the position coordinates input from the locator **11**. The vehicle system **1** recognizes, in S2, the periphery of host vehicle by the vehicle periphery recognition unit **4b** using the detection result input from the millimeter wave radar **12**, the detection result input from the sonar **13**, the detection result input from the LiDAR **14**, and the camera image input from the camera **15**. The vehicle system **1** generates, in S3, probe data by associating (i) the host vehicle position estimated by the vehicle position estimation unit **4a**, (ii) the periphery information indicating periphery of the host vehicle recognized by the vehicle periphery recognition unit **4b**, and (iii) the time information with one another, and stores the generated probe data in the data storage area in S4.

(47) The vehicle system **1** determines whether a transmission condition of the probe data is satisfied in S5. For example, when the travel distance of host vehicle reaches a certain distance or when an elapsed period from last satisfaction of transmission condition reaches a certain period or the like, the process determines that the transmission condition of the probe data is satisfied (S5: YES). In response to satisfaction of the transmission condition, the vehicle system **1** transmits the probe data stored in the data storage area from the DCM **2** to the map generation server **8** via the communication network in S6.

(48) The vehicle system **1** determines whether an end condition of the probe data transmission process is satisfied in S7. For example, when the ignition is turned off, the end condition may be determined to be satisfied. In response to determining that the end condition of probe data transmission process being not satisfied in turn-on state of the ignition switch (S7: NO), the vehicle system **1** returns to S1 and repeats S1 and subsequent process as described above. When the vehicle system **1** determines that the end condition of probe data transmission process is satisfied in response to the ignition being turned off (S7: YES), the vehicle system **1** ends the probe data transmission process.

(49) (2) Driving Diagnosis Process (See FIG. 4 and FIG. 5)

(50) The vehicle system **1** may start the driving diagnosis process when a start condition of the driving diagnosis process is satisfied in response to turning on of the ignition switch. When the vehicle system **1** starts the driving diagnosis process, the vehicle system **1** estimates, in S11, the host vehicle position by the vehicle position estimation unit **4a** using the position coordinates input from the locator **11** (corresponding to a host vehicle position estimation step). The vehicle system **1** recognizes, in S12, the periphery of host vehicle by the vehicle periphery recognition unit **4b** using the detection result input from the millimeter wave radar **12**, the detection result input from the sonar **13**, the detection result input from the LiDAR **14**, and the camera image input from the camera **15**.

(51) The vehicle system **1** transmits, in S13, the host vehicle position estimated by the vehicle position estimation unit **4a** from the DCM **2** to the map generation server **8** via the communication network, and waits for reception of the probe data map from the map generation server **8** in S14. When the map generation server **8** receives the vehicle position transmitted from the vehicle system **1**, the map generation server **8** specifies the probe data map of the segment corresponding to the received vehicle position, and transmits, via the communication network, the specified probe data map to the vehicle system **1** which is the transmission source of the vehicle position. In the driving diagnosis process, instead of S11 to S13, S1 to S6 of the probe data transmission process may be executed. That is, the vehicle system **1** may transmit the host vehicle position by transmitting the probe data. When the map generation server **8** receives the probe data transmitted from the vehicle system **1**, the map generation server **8** may specify the host vehicle position based on the received probe data, specify the probe data map of the segment corresponding to the specified host vehicle position, and transmit, via the communication network, the specified probe data map to the vehicle system **1** which is the transmission source of the host vehicle position.

(52) When the vehicle system **1** determines that the DCM **2** has received the probe data map transmitted from the map generation server **8** (S14: YES, corresponding to a probe data map acquisition step), the vehicle system **1** compares the received probe data map with the periphery information indicating the periphery of host vehicle in S15, and determines a quality of the probe data map by the map quality determination unit **4e** in S16. When the vehicle system **1** determines that a difference between the feature information indicated by the probe data map and the periphery information indicating the periphery of host vehicle and acquired based on the detection result of the autonomous sensor is small, that is the probe data map has high quality (S16: YES), the vehicle system **1** specifies the attention point using the probe data map determined to have high quality in S17.

(53) When the vehicle system **1** determines that a difference between the feature information indicated by the probe data map and the periphery information indicating the periphery of host vehicle and acquired based on the detection result of the autonomous sensor is large, that is the probe data map has low quality (S16: NO), the vehicle system **1** specifies the attention point using the detection results of autonomous sensor in S18 (corresponding to attention point specifying step).

(54) In the vehicle system **1**, based on the input determination result of face image of the driver captured by the driver monitor camera, the driver status recognition unit **4d** recognizes the driver

status in **S19** (corresponding to a driver status recognition step). In the vehicle system **1**, the safety confirmation determination unit **4f** determines whether the line of sight of the driver is directed to an attention point when there exists an attention point, determines whether the driver performs the safety confirmation based on the driver status, and determines whether it is necessary to output the alert in **S20** (corresponding to a safety confirmation determination step).

(55) When the vehicle system **1** determines that the line of sight of the driver is directed to the attention point and thus determines that there is no need to output an alert (**S20**: NO), the vehicle system **1** transmits, in **S21**, the driver's driving data from the DCM **2** to the driving data management server **9** via the communication network for granting point to the driver who has properly performed the safety confirmation, and waits for reception of point data from the driving data management server **9** in **S22**.

(56) When the driving data management server **9** receives the driver's driving data transmitted from the vehicle system **1**, the driving data management server **9** transmits the received driver's driving data to the cooperation service server **10**. When the driver's driving data transmitted from the driving data management server **9** is received, the cooperation service server **10** performs driving diagnosis using the received driver's driving data, assigns points corresponding to the driving diagnosis result in association with the driver, and transmits the point data for notifying the driver about the point grant to the driving data management server **9**. When the driving data management server **9** receives the point data transmitted from the cooperation service server **10**, the driving data management server **9** transmits the received point data to the vehicle system **1**.

(57) When the vehicle system **1** determines that the DCM **2** has received the point data transmitted from the driving data management server **9** (**S22**: YES), the vehicle system **1** activates the HUD **18**, the speaker **19**, the ambient light **20**, and the like, and controls the notification control unit **5a** to notify point grant information indicating that points have been granted in **S23** (corresponding to a notification control step).

(58) When the vehicle system **1** determines that the line of sight of the driver is not directed to the attention point and determines that it is necessary to activate an alert (**S20**: YES), the vehicle system **1** activates the HUD **18**, the speaker **19**, the ambient light **20**, and the like, and controls the notification control unit **5a** to output an alert at a portion close to the line of sight of the driver in **S24** (corresponding to a notification control step). As shown in FIG. **6**, for example, when the vehicle system determines that there is a possibility that a pedestrian B jumps out from a shadow of building A in the left front direction of the host vehicle, the left front area of the host vehicle is specified as the attention point. In this case, when the line of sight of the driver is not directed to the left front direction of the host vehicle, the vehicle system **1** determines that it is necessary to activate the alert. For example, when the vehicle system **1** determines that the line of sight of the driver is in exactly forward direction along the traveling direction of host vehicle, the vehicle system **1** controls the HUD **18** to display a message M such as "Left forward attention" in front of the driver. The alert may be output in various manners under the condition that the driver can recognize the activated alert.

(59) After the point grant information is notified by the notification control unit **5a**, the vehicle system **1** receives the periphery information indicating periphery of the host vehicle, receives the driver status information, receives the detection result from the sensor group **23** connected to the airbag **22**, and the driving participate execution unit **4g** determines whether it is necessary to participate in the driving operation, which is being performed by the driver in **S25**. For example, when (i) the line of sight of the driver is directed to the traveling direction of the host vehicle, (ii) the traveling direction of the host vehicle is not dangerous, and (iii) the speed, the acceleration, and the yaw rate of the host vehicle are normal, the vehicle system **1** determines that it is not necessary to participate in the driving operation of the driver (**S25**: NO). Then, the vehicle system **1** transmits, in **S26**, the driver's driving data from the DCM **2** to the driving data management server **9** via the communication network in order to perform point grant to the driver who continues safe driving

even after the safety confirmation is made. Then, the vehicle system **1** waits for reception of the point data from the driving data management server **9** in **S27**.

(60) When the driving data management server **9** receives the driver's driving data transmitted from the vehicle system **1**, the driving data management server **9** transmits the received driver's driving data to the cooperation service server **10**. Upon receiving the driver's driving data transmitted from the driving data management server **9**, the cooperation service server **10** evaluates a degree of safe driving as a driving diagnosis using the received driver's driving data, performs point grant to the driver corresponding to the driving diagnosis result. Then, the cooperation service server **10** transmits point data for notifying the driver that the points have been granted to the driving data management server **9**. When the driving data management server **9** receives the point data transmitted from the cooperation service server **10**, the driving data management server **9** transmits the received point data to the vehicle system **1**.

(61) When the vehicle system **1** determines that the DCM **2** has received the point data transmitted from the driving data management server **9** (**S27**: YES), the vehicle system **1** activates the HUD **18**, the speaker **19**, the ambient light **20**, and the like, and controls the notification control unit **5a** to notify point grant information indicating that points have been granted in **S28**.

(62) The vehicle system **1** determines that it is necessary to participate in the driving operation being performed by the driver, when at least one of (i), (ii), or (iii) is determined. (i) The line of sight of the driver is not directed to the traveling direction of the host vehicle. (ii) The traveling direction of the host vehicle is dangerous. (iii) The speed, the acceleration, and the yaw rate of the host vehicle are not normal. When determining that it is necessary to participate in the driving operation being performed by the driver (**S25**: YES), the powertrain domain ECU **7** may perform the ABS control as the participation in the driving operation, which is being performed by the driver, in **S29**.

(63) The vehicle system **1** determines whether the end condition of driving diagnosis process is satisfied by, for example, determining whether the ignition switch is turned off or not in **S30**. When the vehicle system **1** determines that the end condition of driving diagnosis process is not satisfied since the ignition switch maintains on state (**S30**: NO), the vehicle system **1** returns to **S11** and repeats **S11** and subsequent process as described above. When the vehicle system **1** determines that the end condition of driving diagnosis process is satisfied by turning off the ignition switch (**S30**: YES), the vehicle system **1** displays, for example, the driving diagnosis result on the center display, the meter display, or the like in **S31**, and ends the driving diagnosis process. As shown in FIG. 7, as an example, the vehicle system **1** may display, on a center display, a meter display, or the like, the driving diagnosis results of six items A to F performed by the driving data management server **9**. Each of the six items A to F indicates one index indicating whether the driving operation of the driver is safe. For example, each item may evaluate a frequency of sudden acceleration, a frequency of sudden deceleration, a frequency of sudden steering, and the like in five levels.

(64) As shown in FIG. 8, upon receiving the driving diagnosis result transmitted from the driving data management server **9**, the portable information terminal **51** of the driver may display the received driving diagnosis result on a display **52**. Under a condition that the driver can recognize the driving diagnosis result, the driving diagnosis result may be displayed in different manners on the center display, the meter display, or the like of the vehicle system **1** and the driving diagnosis result displayed on the display **52** of the mobile information terminal **51**.

(65) The above-described embodiment can provide the following operational effects.

(66) Unlike the related art in which driving diagnosis is performed only based on the behavior of host vehicle, in the vehicle system **1** according to the above-described embodiment of the present disclosure, the attention point is specified using the probe data map. Then, the vehicle system determines whether the driver performs safety confirmation about the attention point based on the driver status, and the determination result is notified to the driver. When the driver does not perform the safety confirmation about the attention point, the driver is notified of the necessity of

safety confirmation so that the driver can perform the safety confirmation. When the driver performs the safety confirmation about the attention point, the driver is notified of the execution of safety confirmation so that a sense of safety and security from the vehicle can be appropriately notified to the driver.

(67) When the probe data map is determined to have high quality by comparing the feature information indicated by the probe data map with the periphery information indicating the periphery of host vehicle acquired from the detection result of autonomous sensor, the vehicle system determines whether the driver performs safety confirmation for the attention point indicated by the probe data map, which is determined to have high quality, based on the driver status. Thus, it is possible to increase the specifying accuracy of attention point using the high reliability probe data map, and determine whether the driver has performed the safety confirmation on the specified attention point in the high reliability probe data map.

(68) When the probe data map is determined to have low quality, instead of determining whether the driver has performed the safety confirmation for the attention point indicated by the probe data map having low quality, the vehicle system according to the present disclosure determines whether the driver has performed the safety confirmation, based on the driver status, for the attention point indicated by the detection result of the autonomous sensor. When the probe data map has low reliability, it is possible to determine whether the driver has performed the safety confirmation for the attention point by specifying the attention point using the detection result of autonomous sensor.

(69) When the safety confirmation is determined to be performed by the driver, the driver's driving data converted into the points serving as the privilege to the driver is transmitted to the driving data management server **9**. Thus, it is possible to develop a point grant service in response to the driver performing the safety confirmation. The driver can receive the points by properly performing the safety confirmation.

(70) When the driver properly continues the driving operation even after the safety confirmation, the driver's driving data converted into points serving as a privilege to the driver is transmitted to the driving data management server **9**. Thus, it is possible to develop a point grant service for the fact that the driver is performing proper driving operation even after the driver has performed the safety confirmation. The driver can further earn points by performing proper driving after performing the safety confirmation.

(71) After the safety confirmation, when the driving operation performed by the driver is determined to be not proper, the vehicle system participate in the driving operation, which is being performed by the driver. Thus, it is possible to appropriately cope with a situation in which the driver does not perform proper driving after performing the safety confirmation, for example, by performing ABS control or the like.

(72) While the present disclosure has been described based on the above embodiments, the present disclosure is not limited to the embodiment or structure described herein. The present disclosure includes various modification examples and equivalents thereof. Additionally, various combinations and configurations, as well as other combinations and configurations including more, less, or only a single element, are within the scope and spirit of the present disclosure.

(73) The control unit and the method thereof described in the present disclosure may be implemented by a dedicated computer provided by configuring a processor and a memory programmed to execute one or more functions embodied by a computer program. Alternatively, the control unit and the method thereof described in the present disclosure may be implemented by a dedicated computer provided by configuring a processor with one or more dedicated hardware logic circuits. Alternatively, the control unit and the method thereof described in the present disclosure may be implemented by one or more dedicated computers configured by a combination of a processor and a memory programmed to execute one or more functions and a processor configured with one or more hardware logic circuits. The computer program may be stored in a

computer readable and non-transitory tangible storage medium as instructions to be executed by a computer.

Claims

1. A vehicle system comprising: a vehicle position estimation unit estimating a position of a host vehicle; a probe data map acquiring unit acquiring, from outside of the host vehicle, a probe data map generated based on probe data; an autonomous sensor detecting periphery information indicating a periphery of the host vehicle; a vehicle periphery recognition unit recognizing the periphery information indicating the periphery of the host vehicle using a detection result of the autonomous sensor; an attention point specifying unit specifying an attention point using the probe data map; a driver status recognition unit recognizing a status of a driver of the host vehicle; a map quality determination unit comparing feature information indicated by the probe data map with the periphery information of the host vehicle indicated by the detection result of the autonomous sensor and determining whether the probe data map has a high quality or a low quality; a safety confirmation determination unit determining, based on the status of the driver, whether the driver performs a safety confirmation for the attention point indicated by the probe data map when the probe data map is determined to have the high quality; and a notification control unit notifying the driver of a determination result of the safety confirmation determination unit.
2. A vehicle system comprising: a vehicle position estimation unit estimating a position of a host vehicle; a probe data map acquiring unit acquiring, from outside of the host vehicle, a probe data map generated based on probe data; an attention point specifying unit specifying an attention point using the probe data map; a driver status recognition unit recognizing a status of a driver of the host vehicle; a map quality determination unit determining whether the probe data map has a high quality or a low quality; a safety confirmation determination unit determining, based on the status of the driver, whether the driver performs a safety confirmation for the attention point indicated by the probe data map when the probe data map is determined to have the high quality; and a notification control unit notifying the driver of a determination result of the safety confirmation determination unit.
3. The vehicle system according to claim 2, further comprising: an autonomous sensor detecting periphery information indicating a periphery of the host vehicle; and a vehicle periphery recognition unit recognizing the periphery information indicating the periphery of the host vehicle using a detection result of the autonomous sensor, wherein the map quality determination unit compares feature information indicated by the probe data map with the periphery information of the host vehicle indicated by the detection result of the autonomous sensor, and determines whether the probe data map has the high quality or the low quality.
4. The vehicle system according to claim 1, wherein, when the probe data map is determined to have the low quality, the safety confirmation determination unit does not determine whether the driver performs the safety confirmation for the attention point indicated by the probe data map, which is determined to have the low quality.
5. The vehicle system according to claim 4, wherein, when the probe data map is determined to have the low quality, the safety confirmation determination unit determines, based on the status of the driver, whether the driver performs the safety confirmation for the attention point indicated by the detection result of the autonomous sensor.
6. The vehicle system according to claim 1, wherein the attention point specifying unit specifies, as the attention point, a blind spot when viewed from the driver.
7. The vehicle system according to claim 1, wherein the notification control unit notifies the driver of execution information indicating an execution of the safety confirmation in response to determining that the driver performs the safety confirmation.
8. The vehicle system according to claim 1, further comprising a first driving data transmission unit

transmitting, to the outside of the host vehicle, driving data of the driver, which is converted into points serving as a privilege for the driver, in response to determining that the driver performs the safety confirmation.

9. The vehicle system according to claim 1, wherein the notification control unit notifies the driver of non-execution information indicating that the safety confirmation is not executed in response to determining that the driver does not perform the safety confirmation.

10. The vehicle system according to claim 9, wherein, as a notification of the non-execution information indicating that the safety confirmation is not executed, the notification control unit performs, at least one of (i) display of the non-execution information indicating that the safety confirmation is not executed at a portion close to a line of direction of the driver or (ii) output of an alert sound.

11. The vehicle system according to claim 1, further comprising a second driving data transmission unit transmitting, to the outside of the host vehicle, driving data of the driver, which is converted into points serving as a privilege for the driver, in response to determining that the driver performs a proper driving operation after performing the safety confirmation.

12. The vehicle system according to claim 11, further comprising a driving participate execution unit participating in the driving operation of the driver, wherein the driving participate execution unit participates in the driving operation of the driver when the driving operation performed by the driver after the safety confirmation is determined to be not proper.

13. A computer-readable non-transitory storage medium storing a driving diagnosis program, the driving diagnosis program comprising instructions to be executed by at least one processor included in a vehicle system, the instructions comprising: estimating a position of a host vehicle; acquiring, from outside of the host vehicle, a probe data map generated based on probe data; recognizing periphery information indicating a periphery of the host vehicle using a detection result of an autonomous sensor that detects the periphery information of the host vehicle; specifying an attention point using the probe data map; recognizing a status of a driver of the host vehicle; comparing feature information indicated by the probe data map with the periphery information of the host vehicle indicated by the detection result of the autonomous sensor and determining whether the probe data map has a high quality or a low quality; determining, based on the status of the driver, whether the driver performs a safety confirmation for the attention point indicated by the probe data map when the probe data map is determined to have the high quality; and notifying the driver of a determination result indicating whether the driver has performed the safety confirmation.

14. A computer-readable non-transitory storage medium storing a driving diagnosis program, the driving diagnosis program comprising instructions to be executed by at least one processor included in a vehicle system, the instructions comprising: estimating a position of a host vehicle; acquiring, from outside of the host vehicle, a probe data map generated based on probe data; specifying an attention point using the probe data map; recognizing a status of a driver of the host vehicle; determining whether the probe data map has a high quality or a low quality; determining, based on the status of the driver, whether the driver performs a safety confirmation for the attention point indicated by the probe data map when the probe data map is determined to have the high quality; and notifying the driver of a determination result indicating whether the driver has performed the safety confirmation.
